_Cyberbullying

Case Study

Cyberbullying is a form of online harassment where individuals are targeted through digital platforms such as social media, messaging apps, or online forums. It involves actions like spreading rumors, posting harmful content, sharing private information, or sending threatening messages.

Targeted People— Cyberbullying usually targets individuals who appear different,
new, or less confident, including school and college students, teenagers, and sometimes even professionals. Victims often hesitate to report such incidents due to fear of judgment or social pressure.

Fictional Scenario— A common scenario can be seen among college students. For
example, a first-year student joins a class WhatsApp group. Initially, everything seems normal, but a few students start making fun of the student's appearance and accent. They begin by posting sarcastic comments, which later turn into memes and edited images shared in the group. Gradually, fake screenshots and rumors are spread on Instagram, increasing the humiliation. The victim tries to ignore it, but the harassment continues daily, both publicly and privately through messages.

Consequences— The consequences of cyberbullying can be serious. It can lead to emotional distress, anxiety, low self-esteem, and even depression. In severe cases, it affects academic performance and social life, and may push victims toward isolation.

This case highlights the need for awareness, responsible online behavior, and timely reporting to prevent such incidents.